

TELLING TIME & CLOCK READING

Grade 2 Mathematics · Lesson Guide

Hours · Half Past · Quarter Past · Quarter To · 5-Minute Intervals

Welcome to your **Telling Time** lesson! In this guide you will learn how to read an analogue clock, understand time vocabulary, and practise reading times to the **hour**, **half past**, **quarter past**, **quarter to**, and **five-minute intervals**.

■ What is Time?

Time helps us know **when** to do things. It tells us when to wake up, when to eat breakfast, when to go to school, and when to play with friends. **Clocks** help us read and understand time every day!

■ Did you know?

There are 60 minutes in 1 hour, and 24 hours in 1 day!

■ Parts of the Clock

■ Hour Hand	The SHORT hand. It moves slowly and points to the hour number.
■ Minute Hand	The LONG hand. It moves faster and tells us the minutes.
■ Clock Face	The round face with numbers 1–12 . Each number = 5 minutes for the minute hand.

■ Time Vocabulary

Learning these time words will help you read clocks easily. Each word tells us something special about where the clock hands are pointing.

Time Word	What it means	Long hand points to...	Minutes
■ O'clock	Exactly on the hour	12	00
■ Half Past	30 minutes after the hour	6	30
■ Quarter Past	15 minutes after the hour	3	15
■ Quarter To	15 minutes before the NEXT hour	9	45

■ The Golden Rules

- 1 Always look at the short (red) hand FIRST — it tells you the hour.
- 2 Then look at the long (blue) hand — it tells you the minutes.
- 3 If the long hand is on 12 — it is exactly O'Clock (00 minutes).
- 4 If the long hand is on 6 — it is Half Past (30 minutes).
- 5 If the long hand is on 3 — it is Quarter Past (15 minutes).
- 6 If the long hand is on 9 — it is Quarter To the NEXT hour (45 mins).

■ Reading O'Clock Times

When the **long (blue) hand** points to **12**, it is exactly on the hour. Look at the short red hand to find the hour number and say that number "**o'clock**"!



1:00 ■ 1 o'clock



3:00 ■ 3 o'clock



7:00 ■ 7 o'clock



10:00 ■ 10 o'clock

■ Reading Half Past

When the **long hand** points to **6**, it is **Half Past**. 30 minutes have passed since the last hour. Look at the short hand to find the hour — it will be *between* two numbers.



2:30 ■ Half past 2



5:30 ■ Half past 5



8:30 ■ Half past 8



11:30 ■ Half past 11

■ Reading Quarter Past

When the **long hand** points to **3**, it is **Quarter Past**. 15 minutes have passed. The short hand has moved just past a number — that is your hour.



1:15 ■ Qtr past 1



4:15 ■ Qtr past 4



9:15 ■ Qtr past 9



12:15 ■ Qtr past 12

■ Reading Quarter To

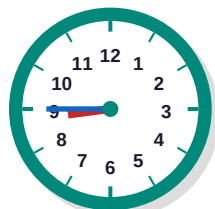
When the **long hand** points to **9**, it is **Quarter To** the NEXT hour. 15 minutes are still left before the next hour. Look at the short hand — it is approaching the next number. That next number is your hour!



2:45 ■ Qtr to 3



5:45 ■ Qtr to 6



8:45 ■ Qtr to 9



11:45 ■ Qtr to 12

■ Counting in 5s — Minutes on the Clock

Each number on the clock face is worth **5 minutes** for the long hand. Count by 5s starting from 12 going clockwise: **5 → 10 → 15 → 20 → 25 → 30 → 35 → 40 → 45 → 50 → 55 → 60 (back to 0)**.

Long hand on...	Minutes	Long hand on...	Minutes
1	5	2	10
3	15	4	20
5	25	6	30
7	35	8	40
9	45	10	50
11	55	12	00

Example times using 5-minute reading:



3:10 ■ 10 past 3



6:20 ■ 20 past 6



10:40 ■ 20 to 11



2:50 ■ 10 to 3

■ Digital vs Analogue Clocks

Both types of clock show the **same time** — just in different ways!

■ Analogue Clock	■ Digital Clock
Round face with numbers 1–12 Has a short hand (hour) and long hand (minutes) You read time by looking where hands point	Shows time as numbers on a screen Easy to read — just read the digits shown Example: 4:30 means 4 hours and 30 minutes
<i>Half past 4 → short hand between 4 & 5 long hand on 6</i>	<i>Half past 4 → shows 4:30</i>

■ Time in Daily Life

We use clocks **every day** to help us stay on time! From the moment we wake up to when we go to sleep, clocks guide our day.

■ **7:00 AM** — Wake up — it's 7 o'clock!

■ **7:15 AM** — Breakfast — quarter past 7

■ **8:30 AM** — School starts — half past 8

■ **1:00 PM** — Lunch time — 1 o'clock

■ **4:45 PM** — Play time — quarter to 5

■ **9:00 PM** — Bedtime — 9 o'clock

Practice Quiz — What Time Is It?

Look at each clock described below. Read the time and write your answer in the **My Answer** column. Check with the ✓ **Answer** column when done!

#	Question	My Answer	✓ Answer
1	Short hand on 3, long hand on 12		3:00 (3 o'clock)
2	Short hand between 6 & 7, long hand on 6		6:30 (Half past 6)
3	Short hand just past 9, long hand on 3		9:15 (Quarter past 9)
4	Short hand close to 5, long hand on 9		4:45 (Quarter to 5)
5	Short hand just past 2, long hand on 4		2:20 (20 past 2)
6	Short hand close to 11, long hand on 10		10:50 (10 to 11)
7	Short hand between 7 & 8, long hand on 6		7:30 (Half past 7)
8	Short hand just past 12, long hand on 3		12:15 (Quarter past 12)
9	Short hand between 1 & 2, long hand on 8		1:40 (20 to 2)
10	Short hand close to 10, long hand on 9		9:45 (Quarter to 10)

Match the Clock — Practice Clocks

Can you name the time on each of these clocks? Write it in words AND in digits!



= _____



= _____



= _____



= _____



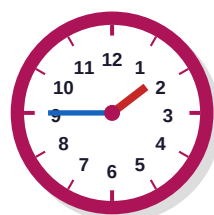
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Answer Key: 2:00 · 5:30 · 8:15 · 11:45 · 3:20 · 7:50 · 10:00 · 1:45

■ Recap — What We Learned

■ Parts of the clock: **hour hand** (short/red), **minute hand** (long/blue), clock face 1–12

■ Long hand on 12 = **O'Clock** | Long hand on 6 = **Half Past**

■ Long hand on 3 = **Quarter Past** | Long hand on 9 = **Quarter To**

■ Each number = **5 minutes** — count in 5s from 12 (5, 10, 15, 20...)

■ Always read the **short hand first** (hour), then the **long hand** (minutes)

■ Analogue clocks have hands. Digital clocks show numbers. **Both show the same time!**

■ Key Tips for Telling Time

■ **SHORT** hand = **HOUR** — always read this first!

■ **LONG** hand = **MINUTES** — count by 5s from 12.

■ **Practise every day** — look at clocks at home, at school, everywhere you go!

■ **Soon you will be a TIME-TELLING EXPERT!**

■ **Thank You for Learning with Us!** ■

Keep practising — you've got this! ■